Tender Is the Night

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Courtesy · 1/2

2ND-01

Tender Is the Night

Courtesy

Sonetto: Timekeeper ...

Sonetto: Ahh ...

Sonetto: Haahh ...

Special Team Captain: We can't leave Timekeeper inside alone! If we break the wall now, we can still ...

APPLe: No, we cannot get in touch with Vertin yet. Without her location, they may get hurt from the blast.

Special Team Member I: The black smoke ...! Watch out! Uggh, uggh!

Special Team Member II: Captain, we needa stay away from the wall! It's too dangerous inside, some of us are affected by enemy's incantation!

Special Team Captain: Then find the nearest window and get in ... we may surround the enemy! Timekeeper must not be caught by the Manus!

Schneider'S Man: Look, bring all your weapons.

Schneider'S Man: Yeah we break out together, with them.

Sotheby: Aha? A group of masked men at the main entrance are rushing over. Oh no! they ... they will see us!

Sonetto: We should go.

Special Team Captain: ... What?!

Sonetto: When Timekeeper is absent, chief assistant Sonetto will be the first-in-command.

Sonetto: Going back now is like lambs to the slaughter. It will only ruin the last chance to rescue the Timekeeper.

Sonetto: The enemy is after us. We are still in danger. It will only cost us more if we act on impulse.

Special Team Member: But ...!

Sonetto: Please trust the Timekeeper.

Sonetto: She will do her best not to put herself in danger.

Sonetto: And the Manus will also want to know why the Timekeeper is immune to the "Storm".

Sonetto: We need to make a rescue plan as soon as we are safe and get her out!

Special Team Captain: Copy that!

The Manus Rioter: Found them!!

APPLe: The rioters are here! Miss Sotheby, the car once hit by the "Heaven Apostle", is it still working?

Sotheby: Hm ... I have no idea ... It's also my first time taking the "Auto Island" ... I used to travel with Hippogriff Rogero ...

Special Team Captain: It still works! But the engine needs a moment!

The Manus Rioter: This is all because of you! Stop!

Sonetto: Everybody, get ready to fight!

Trail ① Black Thursday

小径

Black Thursday

"Are we now witnesses of history?"
The milkman who knew nothing about finance was laughing at the news.
"Hah, finally a hard time for those Wallstreet gentlemen in suits!"
"Gotta go, John."
"Fine, fine." John responded with impatience and tried hard to move those heavy legs. Unlike the rich, he had to deliver the milk for them before sun rose and being late was not allowed. He dropped the newspaper and put out the cigarette. Suddenly he frowned and stopped to ask
"Did you hear that? Someone's playing the pipe. But at this time? He must be nuts!"
"John, I said, stop lying ... Seriously, if you're late again, they really got the reason to fire you this time."
"Don't worry, man. They've said that for years. People need a guy to deliver the milk anyway. There's always a job for the lazy bones like us. I-I mean ... they gotta drink milk, right?"

Courtesy · 2/2

2ND-01

Special Action Team Captain: Come on, come on, we are all counting on you buddy!

Special Action Team Captain: Just a little bit ...

Special Action Team Captain: The engine's ... on!

Sotheby: Wow ... is this also the great arcanum? Next time, please teach me how to master it!

Sonetto: Everybody get in the car! I'm afraid the noise will get us new company.

Sonetto: Miss Sotheby, could we ... stay at your house for the moment?

Sotheby: Stay? Really? That's awesome!

Sotheby: I always plan to invite a friend to my place. Everything is ready. Just ... just need a friend ...

Sotheby: Mr. Karson would certainly not agree, but I will convince him! Please believe me!

Special Action Team Captain: Everyone get on board, don't get left behind. Miss Sotheby, please lead the way.

Sotheby: Sure! No problem!

Sotheby: Oops, Miss reeling, you stepped on my skirt. ... Well, I have a lot of potions hidden here, umm ... If they're broken, I'm over.

Marian: ... Sorry. *cough*

APPLe: Whew! Thank goodness this APPLe doesn't take much space.

Special Action Team Captain: They are behind us! Hmm, the rear view mirror is really something.

Special Action Team Captain: Let's move! Everyone sit tight, grab everything in your reach!

Sotheby: These are the woods we passed before. Mr. Karson said there are many terrible things hiding here ...

Sotheby: Miss Sonetto was chased by a group of ghost-like monsters! Oh, I seem to have read about them in The Guide to Monsters with Good Temper.

Sotheby: Yes! Right under this tree, after we drove away the scoundrels, Miss Sonetto joined us.

Sotheby: This is where the friendship between Sotheby and Miss Sonetto begins! Am I right, Miss Sonetto?

Sotheby: ... Miss Sonetto?

Sonetto: ... Wah ...

Sotheby: Are you ... crying?

Sotheby: Oh ...

Walden

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Forget Me Not: You're back, Miss Druvis.

Forget Me Not: He looks at the cage made of thorns. Two people are locked inside, wordless.

Forget Me Not: What you brought back is as satisfying as expected, Miss Druvis.

Druvis Ⅲ: ... Is that right?

Forget Me Not: What do you mean by right?

Forget Me Not: They are not good people, Miss Druvis. One is a traitor, and the other, a bureaucrat.

Forget Me Not: You've done it right for all the blinded ones.

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Druvis Ⅲ: ... I don't care whether they are good or not.

Druvis Ⅲ: I just want to know ...

Druvis Ⅲ: ... Is it really the right thing to do?

???: Of course not.

???: Shall we meet Lady Vertin as equals at the conference table?

???: Better treatment she deserveth.

TO BE CONTINUED...

Manus Vindictae

2ND-02

Manus Vindictae

???: I have been seeking a chance to talk to you from an equal position.

???: The name is Arcana.

Vertin: Hello.

Vertin: ...

Vertin: The leader behind Manus Vindictae.

Arcana: Thou art acquainted with us.

Arcana: How wonderful. I am pleased.

Arcana: Lady Vertin, here is an official offer that you joinest Manus Vindictae.

Forget Me Not: ...?!

Forget Me Not: Ms. Arcana ...

Vertin: Why?

Arcana: Why? It's simple.

Arcana: I simply adore thy visage, emotionless in each "Storm".

Arcana: I adore that which shineth in gold, nestled in thy cranium.

Arcana: Thy flesh and blood belongen to us, if only a fraction of an ounce.

Vertin: Do I have the right to say no?

Arcana: Absolutely. As I said, we are in an equal position.

Arcana: I ask that thou answer three questions.

Arcana: Answer me, then thou shalt leave ... lest I ...

Arcana: Indulge in thy suffering.

Schneider: Heh ... You can't. Don't waste your time.

Forget Me Not: Ms. Schneider, it is you who betrayed us first.

Schneider: Is that so, Mr. Forget Me Not? It seems ... we have never reached an agreement ...

Forget Me Not: After all, your promise was a lie from the very beginning, Ms. Schneider. You should've known what was coming for you.

Schneider: Heh heh ...

Vertin: So, what are the three questions?

Vertin: And how do you indulge in my suffering?

Arcana: Content thee, my child.

Arcana: The answer will be revealed for both of us.

Arcana: She pulls out countless black lines of slime from her temple. The slime turns into a wand.

Arcana: The first question.

Arcana: What is the ultimate purpose for the Foundation to create the "Storm"?

Vertin: ...!!

Vertin: Wha-what? The Foundation ...

Vertin: Isn't the "Storm" created by you ...

Arcana: Time is up.

Arcana: I was expecting a better answer.

Arcana: Start with her right hand. Her gesture with a gun bothereth me.

Schneider: Uggh!

Vertin: Schneider!!

Arcana: Shh. This is too much for her with a broken hand.

Arcana: Then, the second question. The Foundation experiments on the orphans of arcanists. Is that true?

Vertin: Yes. We are looking for the arcane antibody immune to the "Storm" ...

Vertin: And I am the only successful subject.

Arcana: And the name of that antibody is?

Vertin: Asymmetric ... Immune Protein G ...

Schneider: F**k you ...!!!

Arcana: A story in an inappropriate time, people call it a lie. Thou shalt not be misled by an abominable worm, Lady Vertin.

Arcana: Or her limbs are not my next target.

Arcana: The last question.

Arcana: As the only one who bravest the "Storm" easily, I wonder ...

Arcana: the arcanists thou hast met. How are they?

Vertin: ...

Vertin: ...

Vertin: ...

Vertin: I will join you ...

Arcana: They are not very well, are they?

Vertin: ...

Vertin: ... I rarely meet them. Most of them are deserted.

Vertin: In the mental hospital, the correctional institution, the abandoned orphanage, and the streets that no one sets foot on.

Arcana: We have been deserted by the principles of this world.

Arcana: As though we were born to be so ... eccentric ... and marginalized.

Arcana: Thine eyes are not blinded, Lady Vertin.

Arcana: Welcome home.

TO BE CONTINUED...

Trail ① Manus Vindictae

小径

Manus Vindictae

Manus Vindictae is an infamous extremist organization.
Holding a grudge against humans and contempt for the mixed, these extreme racists only recognize the bodies ruled by arcanist's blood as "mankind."
They call themselves Manus Vindictae and believe they have the ability and power to change everything. They are dedicated to building a so-called proper world where arcanists will stand neck and neck with gods and enjoy the status they believe they deserve. In that case, humans, arcanists on the human side, and the mixed who tolerate the pollution of arcanist's blood will pay a huge price for their existence.
There is no doubt they are lunatic.
One of the two reasons for their madness is their brains: they have a strange prefrontal cortex or some unknown neurons; the other reason is hatred: in those dark ages, arcanists were discriminated, expelled, marginalized, and even slaughtered.
The tragedies that happen every day on the fringes of the society breed their revenge and keep strengthening this army of darkness.
Now they have come onto the stage. What they want is power, freedom, the one and only supreme status, and an overthrown world.

Green Oranges · 1/2

2ND-03

Green Oranges

Schneider: F**k ... It hurts ...

Forget Me Not: Can you stand up, Miss Schneider? Both your right hand and left leg are injured.

Schneider: Arcana walks to Schneider.

Schneider: Get lost! Don't touch my gun!

Schneider: Rotten roots, croaking toads ... You jerk!!

Arcana: Lady Vertin, what do you think of her pistol?

Vertin: ... A great one.

Arcana: Exactly. Which was improved by our finest wandmaker—Druvis III.

Arcana: Take this.

Vertin: I don't need it!

Arcana: And end her life.

Vertin: ...!

Vertin: Why? I've decided to join you!

Vertin: The three questions are all done. It's already ... already enough!

Arcana: Hmm, indeed.

Arcana: It is a mission, a new mission showing our welcome to thee.

Arcana: Thou hast no right to refuse. Complying is thy only choice.

Arcana: Yet, Lady Vertin liketh not this. Then nay it is.

Arcana: Have an orange.

Vertin: ... Orange?

Vertin: Why oranges here ...?

Schneider: Stop running! You orange thief!

Vertin: Schneider? How did you become ... so young ...?

Schneider: Huh? Your clothes. ... Are you from the downtown?

Schneider: Ah ... I see. You are the friend that my sis said helping us pick oranges.

Schneider: Come with me. We have to hurry up. Uncle Cannavale is going to transport the oranges to town tonight!

Vertin: Where ... where am I?

Schneider: Don't be afraid. You can cut the oranges when you climb there. I'll grab you tight!

Vertin: The orange tree feels so real—the warm breeze, the familiar scent ...

Vertin: ... I'm here to pick oranges.

Vertin: Eh hey.

Schneider: Uggh ... uggh ... huh ... huh ...

Schneider: My lord, it's not fair. You're shooting someone seriously injured ... Oh ...

Schneider: Wake up! Come to your senses!

Vertin: Ah, thank you for wiping the mud off my face.

Schneider: Are you really here to help us pick oranges? You don't look very skilled. Or is all the city people like that?

Vertin: Who says I'm not skilled? Observe. Let me pick up that big orange at the top for you.

Vertin: Just climb up here, take a small jump ... then I'll get it ...

Vertin: ... Hey! I got it!

Schneider: Uggh ...

Schneider: Huh ... So it feels like this ... to be shot by my own bullet ...

Schneider: It's not over yet ... my lord. Then ... don't blame me for giving no mercy ...

Vertin: Pap! Pap! Pap!

Vertin: ...

Schneider: Your back is bloody red ... Don't you feel the pain?

Schneider: That son of a b***h! What the hell did she show you?

Arcana: Vertin's back ... such a huge scar on her back. ... How?

Arcana: Interesting. Interesting. Lines. The moon, The eye. What is it?

Schneider: How did you fall from the tree? Your back is bleeding.

Vertin: I ... I think I just saw a critter ... Didn't watch my step when driving it away.

Schneider: Critter ... ahh, I know it. That's the little animal that didn't take the ark, right? I often find them in the bushes!

Vertin: You often see strange creatures ... Are you also an arcanist?

Schneider: I'm ... umm ...

Critters: *appear*

Vertin: Ah, the critters are making trouble now! Wait a minute. I will deal with them soon.

The Door with Wet Paint

小径

An Unpopular Children's Song

Who killed the Snowy Dove?
I, said the cricket.
With my heart and musket I killed the Snowy Dove.

Who saw her die?
I, said the owner of the suitcase,
With my vision and sight,
I saw her die.

Who dug her grave?
I, said the cricket.
With my pick and spade,
I dug her grave.

Who'll make her shroud?
I, said the owner of the suitcase,
With my little suitcase,
I'll make her shroud.

Green Oranges · 2/2

2ND-03

Schneider: Here you are.

Schneider: It's the big orange. Thank you for helping us. Let's have it together! I want to hear the story about the world outside!

Vertin: In the future ... will you also come to town, Schneider?

Schneider: I ... I have no idea. I've never left here. But my uncles have gone to the United States many years ago.

Schneider: My family would also like to go. I heard that ... it's completely different from here.

Schneider: It's the real new world.

Schneider: There are wonders. Full measure of the blessing will be given. Sins will be forgiven. The god there ... loves the world.

Schneider: Umm? Why don't you eat, Miss Vertin?

Vertin: ...

Vertin: I don't feel like it.

Vertin: I've been wondering ... don't you think this orange ... tastes bitter?

Schneider: Why not shoot? My lord ... huh ... just one last shot. ... Why did you stop! Why!

Schneider: Don't I deserve the right to ... die fast?!

Schneider: Or did God finally forgive me. ... He allowed me ... to stay alive!!

Vertin: Schneider?! Why are you covered in blood ...

Vertin: The pistol ... No, no, no! Don't come over!

Vertin: This is the final chance.

Vertin: One shall fall, one shall stand.

Vertin: Schneider dashes to Vertin, her chest bumping into the quivering pistol.

Vertin: Pap!

Vertin: Schneider?! Why ...!

Schneider: My lord ...

Schneider: ... Not now.

Vertin: I'm sorry.

Vertin: ...

Vertin: ...

Vertin: ...

Forget Me Not: Oops, right in the heart.

Forget Me Not: Acccidently, though, our new member is quite the sharpshooter.

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Forget Me Not: Where are you going? Miss Druvis.

Druvis Ⅲ: To where I go.

Arcana: This body, thou hast any idea? Miss Druvis.

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Druvis Ⅲ: Send her back to where she belongs.

Druvis Ⅲ: So that they know Miss Vertin's choice.

TO BE CONTINUED...

Antidote · 1/2

2ND-04

Antidote

Special Action Team Captain: How long before we get to the manor? Miss Sotheby, we've been driving for more than 40 minutes.

Sotheby: Soon around the corner ahead and we're out, then ... huh!

Sotheby: Hah? What's that shadow? It's moving! And there's water on it ...

APPLe: Waffle, that's the Manus Vindictae's believer! Get around now, don't let them see us!

Special Action Team Captain: No! We can't turn around now.

Sotheby: No! They found us!

The Manus Believer: *roars*

Sonetto: Let's fight. Put an end to all that's happening in this ridiculous forest.

Sonetto: We must not let the Manus know where we are going.

Special Action Team Captain: Copy. Let's make it fast!

Self-defense Guide

小径

IMPORTANT! Self-protecc Intel You Muss Not Miss!

IMPORTANT! SUPER SUPER IMPORTANT!
Most important noos of the year that no critter shud miss!

critters! Still trying to avoid hooman kapture? Still looking out for every trep? Our friends keep diss-ah-peeling, never to be seen again! Dere is no peace for us, even if we hide ourselbs in the deepest holey hole of Braddock Heights! We muss STAND and FAIGHT teh hoomans!! We must KONTRIBOOT ESSENSHO POWERZ to protecc fellow creepz!!

Please call dis number if interested: 847-6861XXX

Hi frenz! I looked at the noospaper and copied dis down!
My mother's aunt's sister's good frenz diss-ah-peeled for an entire week! It's terriBALL!
Pls join me! FAIGHT TEH HOOMANS! FUR CRITTER FREEEEDOM!

- Thanks to Megrez δ Potion Atelier's special mix - Magic Translation and Imaging Formula (Basic). Contents are for references only -

Antidote · 2/2

2ND-04

Sonetto: There should be no other enemies. Are you alright? Is anybody hurt?

APPLe: Uggh ...

Sonetto: Are you okay, Mr. APPLe?

APPLe: I got accidentally splashed by their slime. It must contain a high concentration of toxins ... *cough*

Sotheby: Whoa ... you are going mouldy!

Sotheby: You need the antidote made from leeches, glass lizard blood, black fern root and at least two phoenix heart nerves!

Sotheby: They are very hard to find, but fortunately, I have them all!

APPLe: Thank you. But this APPLe might need a little bit of ... Mancozeb.

Sotheby: "Mango Cub"? What's that?

APPLe: Ahh ... ahem ...

Sotheby: Huh! Mr. APPLe passed out!

Sotheby: Don't worry, don't worry! I've got all kinds of potion materials at my house. I'll get them when we're back!

Manor hall

Sotheby: After the "auto island" passing through ten different gardens, they finally get to the gate of the manor.

Sotheby: Phew! Finally got home!

Sotheby: Hmm? That's weird. Where is everybody? Anyone there! Someone needs an antidote!

Sonetto: ...!

Sonetto: Is that ... a unicorn on the wall?

Sonetto: Ah, it turned around ... I thought it was a statue, but it is still alive?

Sotheby: It's not a statue. It is the Quiet Ravenheart.

Marian: The sorcerer and heretic ... oh God, forgive me, Sweet Mary mother of Jesus ...

Marian: Ahhh! What has flown over! God bless us!

Sotheby: Oh, don't be afraid! Hahaha ... that's my dearest Sasana! You are here to welcome me!

Sonetto: Sasana? Well, this is the first time I have seen so many arcane creatures and plants for real ...

Sotheby: Heh heh, it's a mini Schnellgeiste. My father found it near the Blue Ridge Mountains in Braddock Heights.

Sotheby: Don't worry. It no longer sucks human blood. It's my good friend now, and will welcome me home every time!

Sotheby: Speaking of which ...

Sotheby: It's so weird. Where are all the servants at the door today? Mr. Karson would never allow this ...

Sotheby: Mr. Karson! Sotheby is back!

Sotheby: Mr. Karson?

Sonetto: It seems there's no one else but us here.

Sotheby: Well, it's really weird. Forget it. Leave Mr. Karson alone. I have to find the "Mango Carrot" quickly!

Sotheby: I will be back soon! Hold on in there, Mr. APPLe!

Special Action Team Captain: Hmm ... what Mr. APPLe just mentioned, is it really "Mango Carrot"?

Sonetto: I am so sorry. I did not hear it clearly either.

Sonetto: I made a small cut of his leaf to release venom. Hopefully the toxin will take effect slower ...

Marian: Umm ...

Marian: I think what he said was "Mancozeb," an organometallic fungicide humans apply on plants.

Sonetto: ...

Sotheby: Ma ... Mea ... Mon ...

Sotheby: Huh! Not in the index starting with "M". So, Co ... Coe ... Cost ...

Sotheby: Nothing! How could it be possible?

Sotheby: We ... we should have all the potion materials in our warehouse. Is that ... in Latin?

Sotheby: What can I do ... huh! I promised to cure Mr. APPLe ...

Sonetto: Clang.

Sotheby: Umm?

Sotheby: Did I hear something?

Sotheby: Clang. Clang.

Sotheby: Someone is here! What happened? This floor is a private storage area. Servants are strictly forbidden ...

Sotheby: And I never met any servant along the way ...

Sotheby: Phew ... around this corner ... I'm just gonna sneak a peek, making no sound ...

Sotheby: M-Mr. Karson?!

Mr. Karson: Miss Sotheby, you're back.

Sotheby: You ...

Sotheby: Why are you standing in front of our No. 18 vault?

TO BE CONTINUED...

City's Gastrosis · 1/2

2ND-05

City's Gastrosis

Mr. Karson: I am doing the weekly inventory check. I apologise for not welcoming you in time.

Mr. Karson: Umm, however, what happened to your outfit, my lady?

Mr. Karson: Look at the dust on your cheek, and where is the bow on your left arm? Why do you look like just crawled out of the trenches?

Mr. Karson: This ... is terribly bad manners. I hope that Mr. Forget Me Not and the high society you meet today will not think that the Sothebys are a group of savages.

Sotheby: Mr. Karson ...!

Sotheby: You're all right. That's great!

Sotheby: I haven't found you. And the servants are all ... Is there something wrong with our manor?

Sotheby: Did the Manus make any trouble?

Mr. Karson: The Manus? I don't understand, my lady.

Mr. Karson: I assure you that the manor has not been disturbed by anyone.

Mr. Karson: However, after dinner, all the servants somehow got acute gastrointestinal inflammation. Your favourite gardener, Nick, is in hospital now.

Sotheby: What! How could that happen? ... And you ...

Mr. Karson: I was waiting for Master's phone call while they were having dinner.

Mr. Karson: Don't worry, my lady. I have double checked the food. I assume that it's just because of the inappropriate preservation.

Sotheby: Hah! If it's not those bad guys, the Manus, then I have nothing to worry about!

Sotheby: That's it for now, Mr. Karson. I need to find the "Coco Carrot"!

Mr. Karson: "Coco Carrot"?

Sotheby: Yes, that remedy will save my friend's life! They are all waiting for me in the lobby. It's a close call!

Mr. Karson: ...

Mr. Karson: ... I see. But please be at ease, and a decent meal will be prepared for your friends.

Sotheby: Thank you! My greatest Mr. Karson!

Sotheby: Where will the "Coco Banana" be stored?

Sotheby: Ohhh!

Sotheby: ohh ... it hurts so much. How come there are so many green balls running around in the corridor!

???: Grrrrrr Meow!!

Sotheby: Grrrrrr Meow ...? Isn't it the Cactus Cat?

Sotheby: You actually sneaked out while Anna was sick! So, did you come out to steal cactus juice again?

Sotheby: I will get you drunk right now, or the manor will be messed up again!

Trail ① The Proof of Human Eating Gold

小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum

City's Gastrosis · 2/2

2ND-05

Sotheby: Little devils, I gotcha! Ha ha, I'm quite good!

Sotheby: Huh? What's this little bottle next to the barrel? Manco ...

Sotheby: Ah! Here is the magic "Mancozeb" that can cure all! The kind alchemist Sotheby will not give up any patients!

Sonetto: Thank you, alchemist Sotheby. Mr. APPLe has applied the medicine just now, and Miss Marian found the medicine outside the garden storeroom.

Sotheby: Ah ... there are still many arcanists who are better than me.

Sotheby: But why do you look so serious? This is ...?

Sonetto: Come here, Miss Sotheby.

Sonetto: The Manus has taken action.

Sonetto: There is a large scale disease outbreak in the city center. The news is on the radio.

Radio Host: According to the Public Health Service, by 8 p.m. today, 13,469 cases of asphyxiation deaths,

Radio Host: 2,283 confirmed cases of acute respiratory distress syndrome and 181,002 confirmed cases related to gastrointestinal inflammation were reported in 45 regions.

Radio Host: Patients with the new disease have had such primary symptoms as swallowing difficulties, shortness of breath, and gastrointestinal inflammation. The disease is likely to spread in the areas of residence where the patients live.

Radio Host: It has not yet been confirmed as highly infectious. PHS Commissioned Corps has intervened in food supply control and will report its findings as soon as possible.

Radio Host: The east side of Michigan Avenue in the Loup District, the Gold Coast block in the Near North Side, and the River North neighborhood are the most affected areas.

Radio Host: We have also received reports from Evanston and Oak Park.

Radio Host: Until the source of the disease is identified, we ask that general public refrain from eating at restaurants, cafes, bars and any public places. If not necessary, please do not visit major public hospitals in urban areas.

Sotheby: More than 100,000 people are sick?! Oh my gosh.

Sotheby: You look so angry, Miss Sonetto. Are you okay?

Sonetto: ... I am fine. The casualties are staggering.

Sonetto: How did the Manus do that? These are obviously exogenous diseases.

Sotheby: Could it be ... poison?!

Sotheby: Miss Singing Box said that people who are sick would all have stomach pains ... gastrointestinal inflammation, right?

APPLe: But even the hypertoxic ash of Peridexion Tree can't cause such a mass casualty ...

APPLe: And this APPLe's symptom doesn't include gastrointestinal inflammation.

Sonetto: I have recorded the broadcast and ... the Timekeeper's situation, and will report it to the headquarters now.

Sonetto: Whether it is the solution to the "Storm", or the plan to rescue the Timekeeper, we all need the instructions at a higher level .

Mr. Karson: Apologies for interrupting.

Sotheby: Mr. Karson? Ha! Is it time for dinner?

Mr. Karson: Yes. Ladies and gentlemen, dinner is ready. Please follow me to the dining room.

Sonetto: That's great. Thank you.

Sotheby: Do we have Haggis with plum sauce today? I want everyone to try the delicacy my father brought back from Scotland!

Mr. Karson: Of course my lady. Your favorite lekvar haggis will be served soon.

Mr. Karson: These dishes are made with the latest seasonal ingredients from the manor. May this wonderful night wash away our distinguished guests' weariness.

Sotheby: ...

Sotheby: Mr. Karson?

Sotheby: What ... what ... what are these?

Mr. Karson: These are the appetizers.

Mr. Karson: Or would you like me to introduce them, my lady?

Mr. Karson: The 1919 botrytised sweet wine, Moulis en Medoc from Chateau Chasse-Spleen, Creamy Orange Caramels with Toffee Pudding, Puffapod in Herring Soup.

Mr. Karson: Cream of Watercress Soup, Oysters with Mignonette Sauce, and Dill Barometz.

Sotheby: No. That's not what I mean ...

Sotheby: Are you making a joke? But ... this is not who you are, Mr. Karson. ... I don't understand ...

Sonetto: Huh ...

Sonetto: So ... is that ...

Sonetto: What do you say is in the bowl in front of you, Mr. Karson? What is it?

Mr. Karson: Cream of Watercress Soup made of wasabi, blue cheese, watercress, fresh shellfish.

Sotheby: Gosh! Mr. Karson, can't you ... can't you see it?!

Mr. Karson: If there is anything wrong with the cuisine, please let me know, my lady.

Sotheby: I don't know what's wrong with you, Mr. Karson ... but these are not for dinner, not even food at all!

Sotheby: These ... these ... are gold and money!!

TO BE CONTINUED...

The End of Immortal · 1/2

2ND-06

The End of Immortal

Forget Me Not: Ms. Vertin doesn't seem to have any appetite.

Forget Me Not: Or, do you too, wonder how gold bar steak with wine and boiled silver coin tastes?

Choices

1. So is it the symptom for the Storm Syndrome this time?

2. You don't need to do this.

Branch 1

Forget Me Not: **Storm Syndrome**? That's how you call these pernicious habits from the old society?

Forget Me Not: Sounds like ... the Foundation are so satisfied with how the old society works that you call the current situation a "syndrome".

Vertin: ...

Vertin: The Storm Syndrome turned money into food in people's eyes ... It's so ridiculous.

Branch 2

Forget Me Not: No, you wronged us. We didn't do anything but wait.

Forget Me Not: This is just the "mutation" before the "Storm". Nothing else. You know it very well.

Vertin: And this "mutation" has turned money into food in people's eyes ...

Shared continuation

Druvis Ⅲ: How did they eat those gold bars?

Druvis Ⅲ: It is not easy to cut them off.

Forget Me Not: Of course not. Gold is no meat or vegetable.

Forget Me Not: But humans, yes, they are impressive. They had somehow worked out a brand new set of tools dealing with the new "food".

Forget Me Not: A parer that can pare the rough surface of the gold like a potato; a spray gun that can melt bullion within seconds; a cutting board that can prevent cash from scattering all over the place ...

Forget Me Not: There are even cold drinks made from melted Statue of Liberty, for only 50 cents ... Haha, I can't help laughing.

Druvis Ⅲ: But the milk ... was mostly dumped.

Forget Me Not: It's not food anymore. I can't experience the lives of people who were sifted out by the "Storm", but I wonder, for them ...

Forget Me Not: What do they do for eating? For paying?

Forget Me Not: In the "Storm", the thing that dominates their lives is still money. How could it be more ridiculous for the time!

Vertin: Why do you blame them? In the "Storm," there is no life.

Druvis Ⅲ: No life ...

Druvis Ⅲ: You look very sad, Miss Vertin. I do not understand.

Vertin: This burnt branch ... should have come from a rowan tree, right?

Vertin: I have seen this tree in Ireland and southwest England. It is often called "Quickbeam," derived from Old German ... means "stay alive."

Vertin: Rowan is full of vitality. Even if it is transplanted from Europe to North America, it grows vigorously and stretches into a vast forest.

Vertin: In the most dangerous days in the Celtic calendar, people would wear garlands and berries of rowan to pray for its blessing for vitality.

Vertin: However, an unexpected fire destroyed all of them.

Vertin: Just like the "Storm." It's there for no reason.

Forget Me Not: I suggest you stop talking.

Vertin: People, like this branch, whose life was brutally terminated, they worked out new tools, they tried to eat the softened gold bars, and sold the food that's no longer valuable ...

Vertin: People worked so hard to understand life with their own logic ...

Vertin: because they just want to live as much as possible, but not go back in time.

Forget Me Not: Watch your mouth, Vertin!

Druvis Ⅲ: But ... going back in time ... why isn't it real life?

Vertin: Is this little rowan branch really alive, Ms. Druvis?

Vertin: You used arcanum to keep it at the moment when it was burned.

Druvis Ⅲ: ...!

Vertin: Once you dispel the arcanum, it would not be what it is now. I think you are clear, Ms. Druvis, that ...

Vertin: Every tree lives for tomorrow.

Forget Me Not: Enough! How abominable ... This is not where you can give your speeches and such clichés.

Forget Me Not: Since you are still being such a bureaucrat ...

Forget Me Not: Why not let our believers help you get used to the Manus' manners.

Trail ① Clean up
小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum

Trail ② Clarification
小径

Gold Beam In Your Eyes

FRENZ! Dun make that call yet!
Mebbe ... juz mebbe we got it all wrong! Hoomans are not all baaaaaad! Please beleaf me! My bruh's sister's neighbor's aunt saw wif her own eyez that
HOOMANS ARE EATING GOLD!

GOLD! Real gold!
And green papers too! They're eating c-c-c-CAAAASH! They're eating the terriball, painful, and hateful GOLD! They ate and they swallowed! They used fire and knives to cook and cut it, but it still broke their TEEEETH!
I muss tell everyone about this KWIKLY! It changed my mind about hoomans!
It's time! Time to cast aside our PRE-JUDISS!

- Thanks to Megrez δ Potion Atelier's special mix - Magic Translation and Imaging Formula (Basic). Contents are for references only -

A Door on the Trail to the Garden
小径

Outside the Garden Walls

Running from one crowd to another
Hopping from one ship to another
The green bud finally breaks the dark winter
Let the snow melt and the fires die
Push open the narrow door to snow covered garden
Let bygones be bygones
Let the future be itself
The sparrows of spring celebrate after a long wait
Whispers of the oak forest sound like faint breaths

The End of Immortal · 2/2
2ND-06

Vertin: Uggh ...

Forget Me Not: Ugh ...! How dare you!

Forget Me Not: The vase shatters into pieces during the chaos.

Forget Me Not: The deadwood falls out, and surprisingly shows a touch of green as if the incantation has been dispelled.

Forget Me Not: You should not touch other's belongings. Look what you've done!

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Druvis Ⅲ: I heard that ... rowan was often planted next to the Welsh cemeteries, because it would guide the deceased to the next life, so as not to stay in the world and haunt the living.

Druvis Ⅲ: But I was hoping ...

Druvis Ⅲ: Never mind. The arcanum is dispelled.

Druvis Ⅲ: I don't like things being touched by others. Take it away.

Vertin: ... Alright.

Vertin: Only two are left at the large dining table.

Forget Me Not: That branch, you've treasured it for a long time. Is it alright to just give that to her?

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Druvis Ⅲ: You asked me to stay. Is there anything you would like me to know?

Forget Me Not: ... Yes. I've received an instruction from the Guiding One.

Forget Me Not: Our next plan concerns you.

Forget Me Not: Follow me.

TO BE CONTINUED...

The Good News

2ND-07

The Good News

Druvis Ⅲ: It's a nice view here.

Forget Me Not: Indeed. Where your woods can just be seen.

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Druvis Ⅲ: Are you here to ask about my decision?

Forget Me Not: We have negotiated with the local government. They are very interested in your woods.

Forget Me Not: Because of the "Storm", the medical supplies cannot meet the needs of the surging number of patients.

Forget Me Not: They need places to house the patients and refugees.

Forget Me Not: Your woods ... are the best choice, for its abundant space and adaptability to cast the healing rituals.

Forget Me Not: So, have you made up your mind, Miss Druvis?

Forget Me Not: You are always welcome to join us Manus.

Druvis Ⅲ: If I join you, will you reject the government because of me?

Forget Me Not: We have a better plan.

Forget Me Not: In the woods, they are going to build the only major relief shelter in the city. Arcanum will be used as the main treatment here, which means ...

Forget Me Not: Food.

Forget Me Not: Resource.

Forget Me Not: Money.

Forget Me Not: And everything necessary to build Manus Vindictae.

Forget Me Not: We've reached a consensus. Nobody can offer a better assistance in the field of arcanum than us.

Druvis Ⅲ: ... What about those refugees?

Forget Me Not: ...

Forget Me Not: Only those who are sifted out by the "Storm" will become refugees.

Forget Me Not: You will not. You have my word.

Forget Me Not: We hope that on the "Relief Day", you'll show up as the owner of the woods, and offer your help.

Druvis Ⅲ: I am no longer the owner of the woods ...

Forget Me Not: For as long as you need, I will transfer the ownership to you at anytime. Not to mention that the one and only owner of the woods is you, from the beginning to the end.

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Forget Me Not: I know how you feel. What you once had ... is what I should have.

Forget Me Not: I will look after the woods for you, till the moment we start the "Relief Day" plan.

Druvis Ⅲ: Thank you.

Druvis Ⅲ: Forget Me Not has been away for a long time.

Druvis Ⅲ: She looks out of the window.

Druvis Ⅲ: Those trees ... shall sprout?

Druvis Ⅲ: For tomorrow ...

5 HOURS AGO

Endless vines.

Restless slimes.

The enemies are approaching.

And there is no way out.

Schneider: F**k! Not enough bullets. Cover me, my lord!

Vertin: Your wound hasn't healed. Can't get hurt anymore. Stay behind me!

Vertin: This is a cage. She wants to catch us! The exit at two is our last chance! Breakthrough!

Schneider: No, my lord ... it's too late ...

Vertin: Uggh ...

Vertin: It hurts ...

Vertin: The slime on the thorns will make your body stiff. Be careful!

Schneider: All retreats are blocked. We are caught.

Vertin: ... No. We can't be trapped here. Let me try again!

Druvis Ⅲ: Give it up.

Vertin: Flamo Flicker!

Vertin: Ugh!! ... It bounced back ...

Vertin: How? How is the thorn cage so tough?!

Druvis Ⅲ: It's over.

Vertin: Aferoj Away!

Vertin: Umm ...

Vertin: Damn it! Why!

Schneider: You are not pure blood, right? ... My lord.

Vertin: ... I'm not sure.

Schneider: Heh heh, you are like me—crappy guys not good at arcanum.

Schneider: Don't you see it? The pure-blood arcanists and we ... are worlds apart.

Schneider: We can't beat Druvis. You know it. When you push out the old woman in white, you should have figured it out.

Schneider: No matter how we struggle, it makes no difference. We will be sent to Arcana.

Vertin: ... There must be a way. It just takes time.

Schneider: You are braver than most people I've ever met, my lord. But it's not enough.

Schneider: Far from enough ...

Schneider: When it's time, please kill me.

Vertin: What are you talking about?!

Schneider: Left of my chest.

Schneider: The Manus will not let us go. Killing each other ... has always been their favourite.

Schneider: You are much more important than me, my lord. Cherish your value.

Vertin: ... I don't understand ...

Schneider: Remember. Left of my chest. Do it quick.

Vertin: It's too risky, and ...

Schneider: If you want to survive ... we have no choice. Trust me, my lord. I cherish my life more than anyone ... ahem ahem ...

Vertin: But what you said ... She ...

Vertin: She heard it all.

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Schneider: Heh, heh, you are right, my lord.

Schneider: Our destiny ... is her choice.

TO BE CONTINUED...

Trail ① To Cavendish Jr.

小径

What an intriguing plot. Cavendish Sr. must be surprised.

Choices

1. I am surprised, too.

2. Cavendish?

Branch 1

Did you see it too? Did you see that woman's face eroded in the dark? The ecstasy on Cavendish Jr.'s face when he turned away from the others?

He was once very sensitive and very talented. He was a real f*****g genius when he made potions! But now ... He has been swallowed and digested, and yet he knew nothing about it.

Branch 2

Oh, it's a surname buried in dust. It has been shot dead in history. Even Cavendish Jr., who was still alive and once sat in front of you, has taken off his family crown.

"Forget Me Not," what a hilarious, stupid name. That young master with a pale face died, and in his place, something sinister took shape. He battled hunger and suicide countless times, but in the end, he sank into decadence.

That woman gave him a promise. She said a few words to Forget Me Not, and then traveled north, and disappeared in the fog. The Windy City was an unwanted sarcoma which she left behind.

Only when the gun was pointed at his throat could he see clearly what had been on his mind. Therefore, he allows himself to revenge, revenge, re-re-re-revenge, and to die.

Now, the sarcoma belongs to him. He swears to build a magnificent stage there. He is patiently waiting ... to put his meanness, craziness, and quivers under the sun.

Shared continuation

To Lawrence Cavendish

Popular Literature · 1/2

2ND-08

Popular Literature

Vertin: The second, the first, and underground—altogether three secret chambers in the speakeasy. There are mainly material rooms, study rooms, and corridor on the second floor. Cross out.

Vertin: The most likely place to park Schneider ... should be in one of the rooms on the other two floors.

Vertin: It's a pity that the patrolmen could not be confirmed. I'm afraid a battle will be inevitable.

Vertin: Bring the healing potion, other potions, medical equipment, food, masks of the Manus, and ...

Vertin: The rowan branch sprouted. The symbol of protection and blessing ...

Vertin: I'll take it. Go.

Follow the map, avoid the minions and search the rooms.

The Manus's mask blocks their sight. It both shelters and blinds them.

There are no obstacles from the followers and disciples along the way, since a salute will save all the troubles. The tunnel to the underground floor is right ahead.

It is a fork in the road.

Vertin: It's weird. It was a straight path when investigating.

Vertin: Hm? Someone's coming. I should hide from them.

Vertin: ...?

Vertin: Why ...? The rowan branch seems to be pulling me? Does it want me to choose the path where they are?

Vertin: OK, then I'll wait for them to go over.

The Manus Follower I: I saw my grandma in the entrance of the hospital. She choked on cash, and was carried on a stretcher ... She can't even recognize me.

The Manus Follower II: It's nothing, Mr. Thomas. My son Robert's dead. I heard it on the radio.

The Manus Follower II: They are just sifted out by the "Storm," not as lucky as we are.

The Manus Follower I: I don't understand ... 3 hours before you were still ... crying ...

The Manus Follower II: We have to accept all this, accept that the dream of our new age is broken ...

The Manus Follower II: and the fact that we have to fight against the government tomorrow.

The Manus Follower I: Fight against the government?!

The Manus Follower II: Yes. Mr. Forget Me Not told me so. We need to deliver tons of goods to the real "Sanctuary" of Manus Vindictae.

The Manus Follower II: Our safety is not fully guaranteed even with the masks. Only in the "Sanctuary" can we hide from the influence of the "Storm" ...

The Manus Follower II: And then, we set sail anew to the new age, to the new life!!! Just like Miss Vertin, our *roar* ...

The Manus Follower I: What are you talking about? Mr. Robert, y-y-your hand, what the black slime?

The Manus Follower II: *roars*

The Manus Follower I: Wha-wha-what's this! You're like one of those monsters?! Huh! I'll go to find somebody ...

Vertin: Both his appearance and voice have changed, just like the believers who can't talk ...

Vertin: Is it because of the mask? Or Arcana?

Vertin: No, I can't stay any longer. I need to pass through here and go to the underground before anyone else comes.

The Manus Follower II: *roar*

Vertin: "Mine hands, thine order." I am Vertin, a follower like you. Please let me pass.

The Manus Follower II: *attack*

Vertin: He can't be talked into sense ... Is he moving just by instinct?

Vertin: I can only stun you first! Sorry ... Mr. Robert.

Trail ① Long Night Trip

小径

Let's rewind the time to a few years ago.

Choices

1. Why a few years ago?

2. I want to move to the future.

Branch 1

It's for your own good. Lying in front of you is a girl full of mysteries. She makes your mind spin like a top. You scratch your ears, trying to understand what happened exactly.

And all these damn things can be traced back to a long, long time ago, when the monkeys decided to stand on their feet ...

Branch 2

Awesome! Your lofty ambition that a boxer would have is exactly what we need. But unfortunately, I can't take you to the future. Oops, I could, but now I can't.

Now, another person is going to do this. But before we solve this big mystery, I think it's necessary for us to sort out the principal contradiction—

Trust me, you won't regret listening to this story.

Choices

1. Fine. Let's start the bullshit.

2. No. I'm tired of you.

Branch 2.1

I will never be offended by your humor. Okay. The past is waiting for us to look back.

It's winter in the early 20th century. The gloomy rain never stops. The square on West Jackson Avenue is alive with people. There is an Italian Renaissance-styled basilica. You rarely see so many people get together without making a sound.

This is a black requiem mass. The priest is chanting the requiem, and the people mark a cross on their chests.

Choices

1. He must be respectable.

2. He might be powerful.

Branch 2.1.1

"He was a father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace." A woman in a black robe turns to you and whispers.

Branch 2.1.2

"What is power?" A solemn lady shakes her head at you, "Only Lord can forgive us for our sins and judge the right and the wrong, but he does not want power."

"Neither does the father." "He was our father. He dedicated to a sinner of ... Lord shall give him eternal peace."

She turns back. Explaining this makes her unpleased. More and more people are queuing for the funeral. The square is alive with chants here and there.

The Grecos are among them. They're covered by the dark cloud of long-handled umbrellas. Soon, their voices are replaced by whimpers. You can hardly tell whether they are pleased or sorrowful. But you can't find Schneider.

Choices

1. Where is she?

Look in the direction of Mr. Greco's broken left palm. Yes. Look from the bandage-wrapped end at his cuff.

3390 feet away from the crowd, in the shadow of the church, stands the girl you want to see.

She is pale and thin, as if she has just recovered from a serious, long illness.

But her fist clenches, her eyes burn, and her figure is an open defiance of the ubiquitous chants. You don't know why she looks so—so furious. Is she ... what, 11 years old?

And the mass is about to usher in the ultimate climax. It rains heavier. The priest opens his arms to embrace the sky, "The Lord be with you."

"And also with you." Schneider responds in a voice that could hardly be heard. She puts her hand on her heart. This is the first time she responds to the Lord. And it will be the last.

Shared continuation

Branch 2.2

But I will never be tired of you, baby.

I respect your decision. When you're ready for a story, go find your friends. They will tell you exactly what happened.

... While I will wait for you at the next destination, humbly and patiently.

Shared continuation

Shared continuation

Long Night Trip

Popular Literature · 2/2

2ND-08

Vertin: Footsteps. At least five or six people. I should go downstairs quickly.

Vertin: The underground ... another turnoff!

Vertin: The sprout is growing at an unbelievable speed. It seems to be leading the way.

Vertin: Are you really showing me the way? Then ... I'll go left.

Vertin: So close. Just avoided another group of guards ... It's a wine room. Schneider is not here. Next ...

Vertin: This is ... a floating staircase going down?! Is there another fourth space?

Vertin: The sprout is already of a finger's length. There is even a small bud on it. It points downstairs.

Vertin: Fine. Last bet. I'll go down.

Vertin: I found you ...

Vertin: Schneider!

Vertin: She is barely breathing.

Vertin: Black bloodstains and feathers congeal into a silent figure.

Vertin: Weak pulse ... How come? We should have time for first aid ...

Schneider: My lord ...

Vertin: Schneider!

Schneider: Did I see illusions? ... Or are you missing me ... just as I'm missing you? ... *cough* ...

Schneider: Holding me ... so tight ...

Vertin: Thank goodness you're fine. Drink these.

Schneider: Umm uggh ... Too rough, my lord! We just met ... *cough* It tastes awful ...

Schneider: Umm ... Is it the special healing potion?

Vertin: And this. Eat. You must have been hungry for so long.

Schneider: ... What's this, my lord?

Vertin: It's the leftover cake from dinner. I can't bring too much with me. Hang in for a while. They will send you out here tonight.

Vertin: I just don't know ... How did you do that? When you bumped me ...

Vertin: The bullet did hit your chest.

Schneider: ...

Schneider: I don't have much energy to talk, my lord ... I just want to know ... Druvis's last choice.

Vertin: I didn't have the chance to talk to her alone. But I think, since I can meet you now, maybe ...

Schneider: Ahh. It's blooming.

Vertin: *tmr 10am. Heavy fog. Relief Shelter in the woods.*

Vertin: Maybe she shares the same dream with us.

Vertin: Schneider. Now you need to save your strength.

Vertin: Don't open your eyes until you meet Sonetto.

Vertin: I'll see you in the Relief Shelter.

TO BE CONTINUED...

Pearl and Bullet Hole · 1/2

2ND-09

Pearl and Bullet Hole

Sotheby: Okay, it's time to publish the lab results of the 42nd trial of The Chew-Chew Hallucinogen III!

Sotheby: Tell me about what you saw?

Man In Black: The Madonna, dagger, Portland cement blocks ... ahh yuck! It tastes like cement too.

Marian: Wool, twine and scissors, pineapple cherry tomato pizza ...

Marian: Oh no no no no. How sacrilegious ... my Lord!

Mr. Karson: Glenn Miller's trombone collection, medals ... and ...

Mr. Karson: Why is that here—the body of my dog in the trench?

Sotheby: ... Gosh! Really sorry, Mr. Karson ...

Sotheby: Still need to improve, improve! It's alright. Give me more time. Thirty minutes are enough!

APPLe: Turns out the "Storm Syndrome" can distort all the senses about foods ...

APPLe: Working up an appetite with hallucinogen is harder than I thought. Miss Sotheby, we have to hurry up.

APPLe: The longer they can't eat, the weaker they get.

Sotheby: I know. I will make it ... I've learnt so many formulas ... and bought so many of the best ingredients ... I ...

Sotheby: Hey! Stop it, Anna! Don't eat these banknotes! Stop her, Ms. Sonetto!

Sonetto: Stono Swift!

Anna: ...

Sonetto: Sorry. For the humans who have temporarily lost their minds, this is the only way to go.

Sonetto: I received the message from the patrol team. Followers are around the manor.

Sotheby: What?! They must be doing something bad! Stop them. Don't let them in!

Edge, Manor

Sotheby: The rolling wind is not usual tonight.

APPLe: Miss Sonetto, have you heard from the Foundation?

Sonetto: Not yet ... If the instructions are delayed, I am afraid I will implement the backup plan.

Sonetto: To rescue the Timekeeper is the primary goal.

Follower: I'm afraid that reality fails you, ladies.

Follower: Say a bunch of people carrying a stretcher.

Follower: The person on the stretcher is tightly covered with a white cloth. Only one arm with the feather decoration hangs down.

Sotheby: Who are you!

Sotheby: The masks ... You are the trouble maker, Followers? Carrying a small white bed. What's that?

Marian: That black suit ... the feathers ...

Marian: Schneider?! That's my sister Schneider! What happened ... the blood everywhere ...

Follower: What happened? Death, of course.

Follower: There are many bodies, she is the only one to go home. Just for you to know.

Follower: It's our Ms. Vertin's decision.

Sonetto: ... Nonsense!

APPLe: Let me check. The scar on her chest has no sign of slime ...

Follower: Ms. Vertin is already one of us. We share the same blood.

Follower: That's an incredible gunfight, greater than any you've seen last night. Believe it or not, check the scars on the body. They're like sparkling pearls on the beach.

Marian: Oh ... enough. Enough!!

Sonetto: Unforgivable! How could there be someone who spoke such rude words and ... insulted the deceased and the Timekeeper like this ...

Sonetto: May the peace be with us.

Trail ① Sotheby's Potion

小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum

Pearl and Bullet Hole · 2/2

2ND-09

Sonetto: ... The enemies are cleared.

Schneider: Good fight, old woman.

Sonetto: ... Huh!

Schneider: You venge me fiercely. ... *cough* ... Even my stone heart will be moved ...

Marian: Sis?! You're alive ... Thank God ... Jesus and sweet Mary!

Marian: Huh! What is going on? How did you get these bad injuries?

Sonetto: Where is the Timekeeper? What happened to you? Is ...

Schneider: Huh emm ...

Schneider: These are not important. In your heart ... there has been an irrevocable answer for long.

Schneider: Look at this flower. Look at every word on it ...

Schneider: We got it at the expense of ... our lives ...

Schneider: ... I'm so glad ... I can see the starry night.

Schneider: ...

APPLe: She passed out! Take her inside for emergency medical attention!

TO BE CONTINUED...

The Chew-Chew Potion · 1/2

2ND-10

The Chew-Chew Potion

Sotheby: *yawns* ... So sleepy ... The Chew-Chew Hallucinogen IX is almost there ...

Sotheby: What on earth is missing ...

Sotheby: Oops!

Mr. Karson: Please mind your step and don't forget your manners, my lady. Ms. Sonetto is at work. Do not disturb her.

Sonetto: Yes. Sonetto received. We are on our way to the Relief Shelter, close to the woods.

Z: Long story short. Our agents in Washington reported that all the relief supplies are being delivered to Chicago.

Z: What the Manus wants are those supplies. So you need to adjust your plan.

Z: Our first priority is to **stop them from grabbing the supplies and to rescue the refugees**.

Z: There may well be a tough battle today. Just in case, we will send you some fresh crews.

Sonetto: Then what about the Timekeeper? She ...

Z: She knows what she is doing.

Z: You will meet when the mission is completed, Sonetto.

Sonetto: ... Understood. I will do my best.

Z: Thank you for what you have done for the well-being of mankind. Looking forward to the good news.

THe letter from the Foundation: *shoot*

THe letter from the Foundation: An arrow dripping with slime pierces the letter.

Follower: Woods are locked! Go back if you're not transport staff!

Disciple: *roar*

Sonetto: Of course we are the transport staff, though the direction we're going is different from yours.

Sotheby: Hmm? Now they arrived. I feel a lot more awake!

Sonetto: Everyone, please lend me your strength.

Trail ① Critters in the Forest

小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum

The Chew-Chew Potion · 2/2

2ND-10

Although only half a day has passed, the woods are no longer the same as it was.

People sit around the base camp tent, stretchers, and temporary stoves, trying to smile in a pale face.

In the center, next to the huge crucible, there is a high wooden platform as required for a press conference with a Steinway piano.

Commissioned Corps Officer: Hmm let me see, umm Mr. Forget Me Not. So you are the man who's gonna work with us?

Forget Me Not: Exactly.

Commissioned Corps Officer: Show me your physician's license. Are you good at clinical diagnosis? How many patients have you seen?

Forget Me Not: Sir, I'm an arcanist.

Commissioned Corps Officer: Oh, A.K.A con artist, right?

Forget Me Not: I was invited. You've already prepared the crucible and materials I need, why bother asking me?

Commissioned Corps Officer: *tut* ... What are those numskull chiefs thinking!

Commissioned Corps Officer: ... What can this freak do? Playing house with some rotten roots and toad?

Mrs. Durant: Isn't this Mr. Forget Me Not! Fabulous, such a relief that you're here ... *cough*

Mrs. Durant: We haven't had any food for a whole night. We're starving, and can't stop thinking about eating ... I don't know. They say it's cash.

Forget Me Not: Don't worry, I promise everything will be ok, Mrs. Durant.

Mrs. Durant: *cough* I know ... but you will definitely treat people in the white tent zone first, right?

Mrs. Durant: For the love of all the great party times we had! We couldn't take any more of these.

Druvis Ⅲ: So ... there are other zones here.

Druvis Ⅲ: Then ... who is living outside the white tent zone?

Mrs. Durant: Only god knows. I heard that it's a bunch tramps and vendors, I've never seen them before!

Mrs. Durant: However, distinguished lady, you look very familiar. Have we met somewhere before?

Druvis Ⅲ: I am afraid you made a mistake, madam.

Druvis Ⅲ: The military officer gets angry as more and more people gather around here.

Commissioned Corps Officer: Stop dawdling! Since you're here to save lives, hurry up then! Thousands of people are waiting!

Forget Me Not: Keep silent when I'm making potions, sir.

Commissioned Corps Officer: Yeah, pretentious ...

Commissioned Corps Officer: I'll check 30 mins later, to see what the hell you're up to!

Forget Me Not: ...

Choices

1. You are in a good mood today.

2. Why is he so rude?

Branch 1

Forget Me Not: I'm not interested in fruit cuts before the meal.

Branch 2

Forget Me Not: You're surprised? He is just another stupid human.

Shared continuation

Forget Me Not: Enjoy the peace before "the Storm".

TO BE CONTINUED...

Polypotion · 1/2

2ND-11

Polypotion

Vertin: These powders are not poisonous.

Vertin: Also the potion he's brewing doesn't do any obvious harm.

Vertin: This smells nice. Even like ...

Vertin: Why? Does he really want to treat the patients? Impossible.

Tramp: Move! Get outta my way!

Vertin: ...!

Tramp: Where did they hide the medicine? Tear it, *cough* tear it apart! What are these boxes!

Patient: *cough* You can't take these. ... These are the relief supplies of the service corps!

Tramp: Cotton ... cotton ... Ah! It's the quilt! Who wants this s**t!

Vertin: Relief supplies?!

Vertin: So that's it ... Lots of reserved food and oil, medical supplies, emergency supplies, and temporary infrastructure tools ...

Vertin: Without official support, Manus Vindictae needs supplies to gain a foothold in different eras.

Vertin: The so-called peace before the "Storm" is to cover up the transport of supplies!

Vertin: No. Ten is too late. I must meet Sonetto before that!

Tramp: Hey! You wanna steal the potion? Gimme the potion!

Vertin: It's a misunderstanding. I don't have the potion. It will be delivered very soon.

Vertin: Can't be talked into senses, the tramp utters a cry.

Tramp: No! You can't fool me ...! You're afraid of me ... you're afraid of getting burned! ... Gimme that ...!

Vertin: Crap. Other people will be attracted here! I need to take him down ...

Trail ① Intercept the Transport Squad Ⅰ
小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum

Trail ② Intercept the Transport Squad Ⅱ
小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum

Trail ③ Intercept the Transport Squad Ⅲ
小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum

Trail ④ Fight of the Bulldogs
小径

You look nervous, and you all know something's gonna happen.

With your—that ... the brains full of weird ideas—somehow you can feel it. It's your special talent. The talent comes together with your sensitive nerves and rich emotions.

Things are getting messy. New friends and old friends showed up one after another. And, here you are.

Fog rises. It separates the black and the white, just like separating two groups of bulldogs. They're turning around and around, revealing their fangs as if they're trying to tear their own tails apart.

Choices

1. What happened inside the fog?
2. What happened outside the fog?
3. What is the fog?

Branch 1

Good question, my dear. Let's take a look here, right under your feet—

You walked in the area controlled by Manus Vindictae. You stole Schneider under their noses—that little girl who bathed in red feathers and blood. And you whispered to that pretty Druid.

And your rivals are no better people than you are. Look at those wooden supply boxes. People are starving, but the only thing inside is cotton, and cotton, and cotton.

Butter, flour, sugar, and everything sweet were intercepted and sent to Chicago, thanks to those black dogs. But that's alright, cotton will feed you too.

Come on. Follow me and look. Look at the place where the air becomes humid because tears are shed. Here's a sobbing mother, with an infant in her arms. Her child is dying, while those nobles are worrying about their silk clothing, checking if their jewelry gets stained with mud.

Branch 2

Yes, of course you'd wonder. You haven't been out there for so long that you know nothing about them or their stories. I'd be as curious if I were you.

The smarties in the Foundation also noticed what Manus Vindictae has done. They stopped the transportation team while approaching the fog.

The girl in the black suit has returned to where you asked her to be. They take good care of her.

And your loyal, beautiful friend is fighting for you, together with that easily startled rocking girl, the quick-thinking boy, and a red fruit.

She's on her way to save you. She overcomes one obstacle after another, like a prince crossing the thorny land of a sleeping castle, like a legend puppy gripping its owner's clothes and pulling him from a flaming fire.

Branch 3

You picked an interesting question, as interesting as yourself, little freak.

You do have a distinguished brain, with so many distinguished things inside. It's not bad. Keep that. Use it more often.

Let's go back to your question. The fog—no doubt it's created by the barkeeper. It's like bartending, put this in, put that in, stir them in a crucible, and you get what you want.

It works like real fog; it blocks eyesight, hides secrets, and slows down those who wanna get in or get out. It also works differently from the real fog, for it is hallucinating, intoxicating, and getting people forever lost at the mysterious fork roads.

He is shrewd and insidious. But smart guys are everywhere, especially now and here.

What we have to do is wait. Wait. Wait for it.
But not for too long, that'd be stupid. You know, a proper wait—wait for it!

The show is about to begin. You'll see the most magnificent performance of all time! Oh, of course, you can join it, stand in the center, bring your pretty suitcase, hold your umbrella, and give us a badass fight.

Wait and see. The fog between black dogs and white dogs won't last for long. You can't turn away from those biting, tearing, and bleeding.

Grab your popcorns, my love.
Then sit tight, hold still. You may cry, or may not. I don't give a f**k.

Shared continuation

Fight of the bulldogs

Polypotion · 2/2

2ND-11

Vertin: ... Sorry. Take a rest. You can no longer waste your energy like this.

Vertin: An unguarded trail hides behind the bushes.

Vertin: A smell of stale, burnt gasoline lingers.

Druvis Ⅲ: Are you running away?

Vertin: Ms. Druvis ...

Vertin: No. I'm picking them up.

Druvis Ⅲ: Then you should not pick this way. Are you still as lost as you were at the beginning?

Druvis Ⅲ: It is heavily guarded in the front. There are more serious crises than just now.

Druvis Ⅲ: Even so, are you still moving forward?

Vertin: ... Yes.

Vertin: Until we see "tomorrow" with our own eyes.

Vertin: Will you come with me, Druvis?

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Druvis Ⅲ: Your friends are on the way.

Druvis Ⅲ: I "see" ... the huge engines are roaring towards here.

Druvis Ⅲ: What "we" desire is being removed; what "we" despise is being rescued.

Druvis Ⅲ: But "our" enemies are still increasing. From north to south. From east to west.

Druvis Ⅲ: The "Storm" is coming.

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Druvis Ⅲ: I accept your invitation.

Druvis Ⅲ: But this is **a formal farewell**. I need to see my woods one last time and engrave it in my mind.

She fiddles with her hair, walking towards the shelter.

Depths, Scorched Woods

Sonetto: Good? This should be the third transport truck we seized.

Sonetto: In order to avoid attention, the Manus reduced the number of guards for the supply transport. They must have never expected our attack.

Sonetto: Captain, lead the team to escort the three vehicles back to the manor.

Sonetto: You and the others, follow me to the Relief Shelter.

Team members: Copy that!

Schneider: Have you made the latest hallucinogen, my lady? If you are confident, you can pour it into my mouth ...

Sotheby: Thank you for being my experimental subject!

Sotheby: But even if it's successful, you won't have any reaction.

Sotheby: You don't want to eat gold bars ...

Schneider: Humph? Is someone questioning my contribution?

Schneider: I am willing to try it for my family first ... Isn't that okay? My lady is really hard to understand.

Schneider: After all, I am the woman who escaped from Druvis III. ... Compared to any of you ...

Schneider: I know what death ... tastes like ...

Sotheby: Ms. Druvis, who's that? You mention her a lot. Is it only me who does not know her?

Sonetto: I have read her investigation report. She is the stepdaughter of Washington State Forestry Tycoon.

Mr. Karson: You mean the Weyerhaeuser? Master once dealt with them.

Mr. Karson: However, the family suffered a great deal of misfortune. It was even in The Times.

Mr. Karson: The Soviet Union artificially lowered wood prices and that led to their bankruptcy. Fate can't be resisted.

Mr. Karson: Let alone ... no, never mind.

Sotheby: Why did you hesitate, Mr. Karson?

Mr. Karson: Nothing, I assume that Ms. Druvis will prefer not to bring up such an old story again.

Mr. Karson: It is also not my place to meddle in private affairs. Please don't take it to heart.

Sonetto: Be careful, everyone. We have entered the area of the Relief Shelter.

Sotheby: Wow ... the fog has risen in the woods!

Sotheby: *cough* ... What's the funny smell? I can't control myself!

Sotheby: *cough* ... And I'm a little dizzy ... Whoa ... whoa ...

Sonetto: Come here! Hold your breath. The white fog should be a protective incantation to hide the Relief Shelter.

Sonetto: It is now 35 minutes to ten.

Sonetto: The refugees nearby are not well, and the guards are doubled.

Sonetto: From now on, everyone please proceed with caution. Ensure that you are not disturbed by the fog.

Sotheby: Yes. *cough* No problem!

Sotheby: Move as much as possible before we meet Miss Vertin!

Sonetto: Good. Repeat. **Transfer supplies. Rescue refugees**!

Sonetto: Let's move!

TO BE CONTINUED...

About the New Era

2ND-12

About the New Era

President Michel: Oh, thank you, I've been starving for so long. Hmm ... not bad! Give me another potion.

Forget Me Not: Of course, suit yourself please.

Forget Me Not: Oh. Ms. Druvis, you're back. Have you finished potion distribution?

Druvis Ⅲ: Yes. Patients in the stretcher zone have also taken the potion. They are feeling a bit better.

Commissioned Corpst: What's that smell? You just gave it out before we sample them?

Commissioned Corpst: The press is here in no time! You have to be fully responsible for any accident!

Druvis Ⅲ: The press?

Commissioned Corpst: Aren't you the ones who want a press conference? Just to show off what the arcanists do in the relief!

Commissioned Corpst: Hey! Gimme some potion! These toad freaks ...

Commissioned Corpst: He is too late.

Commissioned Corpst: Following the believer, the journalists pack into the square with cameras on their shoulders, looking around the place.

Druvis Ⅲ: I didn't know there will be press today.

Forget Me Not: Forgive me for that I want to hold a banquet before the "Storm", Miss Druvis.

Forget Me Not: After all, for us Manus Vindictae, this era is no longer of any value.

Commissioned Corpst: The potion ... tastes so familiar ... the smell ...

Commissioned Corpst: *spitting* This is beer?!

Commissioned Corpst: This is prohibited! Where did you get it?! I knew it, I knew we can't trust these insane people! Get them all!

Forget Me Not: Insane? No, we can't be more sane.

Forget Me Not: Forget Me Not turns to him, with a weird, excited smile on his face.

Forget Me Not: He has waited for so long just for this moment to show his true self.

Forget Me Not: We are neither insane, nor ever hysterical.

Forget Me Not: Not to mention practicing hypocrisy, screwing money through all the ridiculous and absurd decrees.

Forget Me Not: The prohibition has lasted for almost 10 years, how could you know it's beer right away?

Forget Me Not: What a hypocritical wretch!

Commissioned Corpst: Uggh ... ahh!!

Commissioned Corpst: As Forget Me Not raises his hands, people start to explode one after another. The rude officer falls down, with a broken stomach and guts all over the place.

Vertin: What?!

Vertin: He used the potion as fuel for explosion?

Forget Me Not: Distress cometh upon those not of me. Present me thy flesh, soul and abhorring.

Broke Celebrity: Why!!! Arrgh!!!

Forget Me Not: I give you death, rejoice, may the wine in Heaven be without measure.

President Michel: Don't ... don't kill me ... Arrgh!

Journalist: Help! ... Run! Run!

Forget Me Not: I will not kill you. I demand you vultures faithfully record everything that happened.

Forget Me Not: I demand you see with your own eyes—how does an inferior take everything he has been deprived of.

Forget Me Not: Just! Like! This!

Mrs. Durant: No! ... Help me!

Druvis Ⅲ: Mr. Forget Me Not.

Druvis Ⅲ: The fall has gone. No need for more blood.

Forget Me Not: What makes you doubt, Miss Druvis?

Forget Me Not: "The Storm" is coming, we have accomplished our missions. And everything here should be doomed!

Druvis Ⅲ: ... The "Storm" is only the "Storm". It is not destiny.

Mrs. Durant: *cry* Miss, please help ...

Mrs. Durant: No! You ... you are ... I've met you!

Mrs. Durant: You are the daughter of the late Weyerhaeuser?!

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Journalist Ⅰ: Those Weyerhaeusers! They burned themselves after bankruptcy...

Journalist Ⅱ: No, not self-burned! Their daughter who studied dark magic burned them alive!

Journalist Ⅰ: Worth it if I take a photo of her before I die! Move! Let me take one!

Druvis Ⅲ: ... No.

Druvis Ⅲ: Don't do this!

Druvis Ⅲ: Flash lights, questions after questions. Nothing different.

Druvis Ⅲ: I have not studied dark magic.

Journalist: Did your parents' death have nothing to do with you? I heard they were always against you learning dark magic.

Druvis Ⅲ: I have not studied dark magic. I was born an arcanist.

Journalist: Which means you decided to burn them alive because of their disapproval.

Druvis Ⅲ: I did not burn them alive. The fire was caused by gasoline. They told me ... it's twenty barrels of gasoline.

Journalist: It is not possible that 20 barrels of gasoline can cause such a fire. It is dark magic, Miss.

Journalist: It is said that you always objected to their plans of cutting the trees and selling the woods. So they did it at midnight to avoid you.

Journalist: However, you were at the scene of their death.

Druvis Ⅲ: ... I wanted to tell them

Druvis Ⅲ: I have just learned a new "arcane skill" ...

Druvis Ⅲ: I do hear the sound of trees. I know there is a way ... to make us all survive ...

Druvis Ⅲ: No need to sell the woods. No need to level up trees. No need to file for bankruptcy ...

Druvis Ⅲ: We can go back to the life we had ... the kind of life they expected.

Journalist: So you chose to escape the debt by burning down the woods.

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Druvis Ⅲ: I will find out the truth. I will find the arsonist. I will find the answer I never knew.

Vertin: Druvis! Druvis ...!

Druvis Ⅲ: I will not let the woods grow.

Druvis Ⅲ: I will defend everything about them.

Druvis Ⅲ: I will ... *cry*

Vertin: Enough! Don't live in the past!

Choices

1. Open your eyes!

Vertin: Your blessing ... once brought me fortune and hope.

Vertin: Now I will give this blessing to you. I will share my "tomorrow" with you.

Vertin: Watch your steps. Leave with me!

Druvis Ⅲ: ...!

Druvis Ⅲ: Vertin ...

Druvis Ⅲ: My tomorrow ...

Vertin: Leave the flashlight. Get up. I'll carry you and jump out!

Druvis Ⅲ: ... Thank you.

Forget Me Not: Are you being officious, or just revealing your sting?

Vertin: Forget Me Not, sooner or later, you will be destroyed by your own hatred.

Forget Me Not: I know, but I'm sorry that you'll never live to see that day.

Forget Me Not: He gets out his wand and a disciple appears behind him.

Manus Messenger: *roaring*
<We were attacked.>

Manus Messenger: ㄐㄧㄣˇㄕㄣˊㄇㄧˋㄒㄩㄝˊㄐㄧㄚㄎㄜˇㄩㄝ
<The Foundation has hijacked our supplies and is still breaking the outermost protective spell, intends to attack!>

Forget Me Not: ...

Vertin: ...

Forget Me Not: So, you left in such a hurry just to get your accomplice, bumblebee.

Forget Me Not: It's time to clean the garden, my disciples!

Manus Believer: *roars*

TO BE CONTINUED...

Trail ① Gossip Magazine

小径

■■■ Formula: 1920s

I am so sick of him! An "arcanist" acting like the upper class! He even attended the parties in the lords' mansions. He is nothing like those who hide their identities: they know how to suck up to humans and cover up the ugly side. Look at him! A drink that turns into alcohol only when you drink it? He should be hung, and shot, and burned! Get out of our street!
—Big Mouth Bulletin: From Readers, 1927, Issue 1224-1

He must be a weird monster! I heard a woman married a snake and bore a horrible child. That must be him! That's why he hides everything about himself. The other day I saw with my own eyes he had scales under those long sleeves, one next to another embedded in his flesh. On the fourteenth night after that, I woke up with a start from the nightmare to find a woman with a strange head staring at me from the darkness outside the window. She didn't breathe or say a word, and just put her face against the window like some dead animal ... That must be his underling ...
—Big Mouth Bulletin: From Readers, 1927, Issue 1224-1

He gave me a hand when I needed help.
—Big Mouth Bulletin: From Readers, 1927, Issue 1224-1

His alcohol has bewitched too many people. That green stuff can open anyone's mouth: secrets of the Anti-Saloon League, plans of the Synagogue, and even rumors of the Congress, he knew them all. There's someone different behind him. I don't know who that is, but they must be unbelievably powerful. No one's going to believe my words. I don't know why he is still alive now. That's horrible. I mean it.
—Big Mouth Bulletin: From Readers, 1927, Issue 1224-1

Forget Me Not is the most celebrated mixologist of the early 20th century and a perfect embodiment of the American Dream. His real name is unknown to the public, and rumors about him abound. Some claim he's a wicked drug dealer, Satan reincarnate, a political spy, or even the love child of an evil serpent and a human. Although his background remains

shrouded in mystery, it doesn't stop us from tasting heaven in his wonderful creations.
—Big Mouth Bulletin: From Readers, 1927, Issue 1224, Epilogue

Trail ② Enemy at the Corner I
小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum

Documentary
2ND-13

Documentary

Sonetto: Why ... why can't the fog be cleared? ... How can we get in?

Sonetto: I've already heard the Timekeeper's voice. She is close to us. She needs help!

APPLe: The arcane skill on the fog is far more powerful than ours. It's countering us.

Sonetto: I can't wait any longer. I don't want it to be ... like the last time ...

Sonetto: There must be a way to focus all of our arcanum simultaneously.

Sonetto: As long as we're more powerful, even just for a second! ... As long as there's a breach ...

???: Sometimes, things can be fixed without arcanum.

Sonetto: Huh ...!

X: It is also a good way ... to learn from human experience.

Sonetto: Mr. X, and ... Regulus!

Sonetto: So the reinforcements sent by the Foundation are you guys. Excellent!

Regulus: Phew! Finally we catch up. I'm cream crackered!

Regulus: No worries, Sonetto! We will rush in and meet Vertin!

Sonetto: What did you just say, Mr. X? Is there another way?

X: The essence of arcane power ... lies in the intuitive insight into everything.

X: And our human friends are good at logical deduction based on awareness, which is rejected by the arcanists.

X: Since we can't beat the Manus in terms of arcanum, then ...

X: He knocks at the weird-shaped pipe hiding under his coat.

X: Why not try to use a counter-intuitive logic experiment to open the door of this protective incantation?

X: Anyway, as long as the caster can be interrupted, anything is fine.

Sonetto: Hmm, are you going to avoid the surveillance of the fog, and go directly in to break the incantation?

Sonetto: What counter-intuitive experiment will you do?

X: Heh heh, check it out.

X: The next experiment is: within three minutes, use this copper pipe to boil a pot of water in the distance!

Sonetto: A Goldberg Machine! That explains it. Now I understand!

Regulus: How did you get it? Uhh, I think people at the Foundation are more or less freaks.

Regulus: But well, the kind of machine designed to be meaningless at every step is indeed counter-intuitive.

Regulus: Maybe it really will release us from the control of arcanum. Haha! It's a gas!

Sonetto: So, please start the experiment soon! We do not have much time.

Sonetto: Please hold on, Timekeeper. Reinforcements are coming right away.

Clinic, Scorched Woods

Forget Me Not: There are so many of us. How many rounds can you make it through?

Vertin: Your good luck won't last long.

Vertin: Despite the coming "Storm," or the Foundation's reinforcements, there is only one ending to your story.

Forget Me Not: Ha ha! I don't care about the words of a dying man.

Forget Me Not: Miss Druvis, I've found the truth for you.

Forget Me Not: The culprit to blame, the arsonist, is right here in the shelter.

Forget Me Not: As long as you keep your promise to stay.

Druvis Ⅲ: No ... It's not important anymore ...

Forget Me Not: Not important?! He ruined everything with just 20 barrels of gasoline!

Forget Me Not: That's him. Do you know who he is?

Tramp: Arrgh ... Uggh ...

Forget Me Not: A firefighter who lost his job because of the depression! Thought that putting out a fire could win him his job back!

Forget Me Not: Look at those hands, they set the fire, burned your families alive, burned your woods into ashes!

Forget Me Not: How could you ... how could you even forget such pain like that? Druvis!

Druvis Ⅲ: ...

Druvis Ⅲ: Thank you, Mr. Forget Me Not.

Druvis Ⅲ: For your help in the flames in the past. For your compassion for someone you've never met.

Druvis Ⅲ: Today is just the same as before. In the past, I tried everything to protect something.

Druvis Ⅲ: But before I knew it, I already stood on the opposite side of myself in the past.

Druvis Ⅲ: My woods will not perish.

Druvis Ⅲ: They will live with scars, and new shoots in spring.

Druvis Ⅲ: They will look haggard, but at the same time they will stand upright.

Druvis Ⅲ: They will continue to grow, recording everything about their own history, territory, residents, and an anecdote of a reckless firefighter in the 1920s.

Druvis Ⅲ: They will keep growing upwards, until they cross the millennium.

Druvis Ⅲ: Huh ... please allow me to bid you farewell, Mr. Forget Me Not.

Forget Me Not: ...

Forget Me Not: I don't understand ... I can't understand ...

Vertin: We belong to the future, Forget Me Not.

Vertin: It's raining.

Vertin: What comes after the rain, is a bottle of boiled water pouring down on him.

Vertin: But he stands still.

Forget Me Not: ... It's still February. But for you, isn't the spring already here?

Druvis Ⅲ: I think I should go back to where I belong.

Forget Me Not: Flowers. More flowers. Without being noticed, they are sprouting on the scorched earth and become flower fields.

Journalist: The forget-me-not flower field?! I wrote about the place ... in Rainier ... Urrgh!!!

Forget Me Not: ——

Forget Me Not: That journalist falls down in a puddle of her own blood.

Forget Me Not: Footsteps are getting closer. The incantation has dispelled, and people who dispelled it are running towards here.

Forget Me Not: These seem nothing to Forget Me Not, as he just turns around and walks to the piano.

Forget Me Not: Next time you see a wounded snake, don't save it no more.

Forget Me Not: Crush it to pieces.

Forget Me Not: Smear its tongue with the ashes of despair.

Forget Me Not: People are coming here. This time, they are our companions.

X: Wow. What is that man going to do? What a terrible arcanum fluctuation ...! If I knew it I wouldn't have come in!

Regulus: Ahh hah? Are you having a quarrel? Looks like it poured at a bad time?

Sonetto: Timekeeper!

Vertin: Sonetto ... Regulus ...?

Sonetto: You're not hurt! That's great!

Sonetto: I am sorry. You protected me when the wall fell ...

Sonetto: But I could not save you ... and even let you confront the Manus alone. ... I am sorry ...

Vertin: Your hands are trembling, Sonetto ...

Vertin: Calm down. You did nothing wrong.

Vertin: We are together now, aren't we? There are more challenges for us to take.

Vertin: It's not the time to catch up.

Sonetto: ... You ... you are right.

Sonetto: We are late, but not too late ...

Sonetto: Timekeeper, I-I am so glad that you are safe and sound!

Sonetto: What comes next is the final battle!

Sonetto: This time, please let me protect you.

TO BE CONTINUED...

Trail ① The Secret Business

小径

Excerpt from the New York Times

> Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
> The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.
>
> The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
> On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.
>
> Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

Trail ② Enemy at the Corner Ⅱ

小径

The Opportunist and The Sticky Gum

Puppet

2ND-14

Toy Dogs

Sotheby: Oh ...! It really hurts! I got hit!

Mr. Karson: My Lady! Stand behind me!

Sotheby: The piano keeps playing.

Sonetto: Urrgh ...!

Sonetto: The battle is intense. The number of the injured on both sides is still increasing ...

Sonetto: We have assembled so many combatants ...

Sonetto: But if that's the Manus's power, I will then need ... much more training ...

Arcana: You are all bleeding.

Sonetto: Huh!

Sonetto: You are ...

X: Whoa, here comes a trickier guy?!

Arcana: Heh heh ...

Vertin: We're in trouble ...!

Vertin: Everybody, keep 50 feet away from her!

Arcana: Vertin, my lovely puppet, art thou leaving?

Vertin: Correct.

Vertin: And one day ... I will be back and beat you personally.

Arcana: Heh heh, how wonderful.

Arcana: Lady Vertin ...

Arcana: Thou lead them, from vanity to reality, from the past to the present.

Arcana: Thou seek the light, sacrifice thy body, conduct forth carrying sorrows.

Arcana: Vertin, the saviour that people follow.

Arcana: Blessings be unto you, whose people shall be no more in hours.

Arcana: Mayst thou be in peace ...

Arcana: When the rain falls into the sky.

Arcana: As always.

Vertin: ...

Vertin: As she raises her hand, black slime gathers and becomes the disciples.

Arcana: Arise.

Arcana: The disciples follow her order, walking towards Vertin.

Arcana: Be gone.

Vertin: The enemy is coming! Everybody protect yourselves!

Vertin: Other members of Manus Vindictae run to Arcana. They fade in the rain.

Arcana: It's raining. Home we shall be.

Arcana: It's hard to understand her smile.

Arcana: Leave no regrets in these final hours ...

Arcana: Goodbye.

Sonetto: ... They ran away!

Vertin: We can't relax yet. Defeat the shadows first! Please everybody hold on!

Vertin: Finally ...

Vertin: ...

Sotheby: Amazing! Amazing! We finally defeated the Manus scoundrels!

X: Oops, it's really thrilling! ... I don't think I'm good for the field work.

Sonetto: Those who are not injured, please take charge of the inventory, and gather all the refugees.

Vertin: Whose people shall be no more ...?

Vertin: ...

Vertin: There are ... six hours left ...

Vertin: In the following time ... symptoms will get worse ...

Vertin: The influence scope of the Storm Syndrome will be further expanded ...

Vertin: How shall we spend ... the last hours? And what can I do?

Schneider: Let's hear everyone's wishes. How about that?

Vertin: Schneider ...

Schneider: My lord, you're actually lying here defenceless. ... Heh Heh.

Schneider: We, have been with you for a long time. No reward? No way ...

Vertin: ...?!

Sonetto: Schneider, what are you doing!

Sonetto: Don't suddenly get so close to her!

Vertin: Sonetto ...

Sonetto: Timekeeper, the supplies have been counted, and are being transported to the headquarters. The refugees are also being settled.

Sonetto: I just received the news that here is not the main target for the Manus.

Sonetto: This morning, Arcana led other members and robbed a large amount of supplies from Washington.

Vertin: ...

Sonetto: What is ... the next mission for us? The "Storm" ... it should be coming soon ...

Vertin: Yes.

Vertin: Sonetto ...

Vertin: This time, I want to hear everyone's wishes.

TO BE CONTINUED...

Empty Wardrobe

2ND-15

Empty Wardrobe

Sotheby searches all over the place, and stops before the crucible.

Sotheby: Wow ...! How could there be such a big crucible! Amazing!

Sotheby: The potion here is ... beer? No.

Sotheby: The formula is very similar to my hallucinogen! But it's alcoholic!

Sotheby: Oh my gosh. How did he make it! What is the most crucial material?

Sotheby: She dips her finger in the potion and puts it in her mouth. Soon she writes something down on the paper hastily.

Sotheby: Eh ...

Sotheby: Ah ...! That's it. I got it? I got it!!

Sotheby: I finally got the right answer!!

Regulus: ...

Regulus: Who is that alive and kicking young lady over there?

Sonetto: She is the heir to an auction house in London, England, and helped us a lot this time.

Regulus: Oh! ☆

Regulus: Hi! Ms. Sotheby!

Regulus: We're taking notes of everyone's wishes. I'd say, would you like to come and have a look?

Sotheby: Hah? Take notes of wishes?! I have many wishes! I am coming!!

Regulus: Come here. Just register with Vertin!

Marian: My wish?

Vertin: Yes.

Vertin: ... If this was the last moment in your life ... what wish would you want to make?

Marian: My lord, are we gonna die?

Vertin: ...

Marian: We are starving for too long, my lord ...

Marian: I want to have dinner with my family. For us Italians, that's the best moment of life.

Sonetto: Mine?

Sonetto: I have no wish ...

Sonetto: What is your wish? May I realize it for you?

X: A few refugees have already passed out from hunger. Needless to say, you know what they need, right?

X: For me, a cup of espresso would be great.

Sotheby: I already knew the right formula for the hallucinogen! I want to realize everyone's wishes!

Sotheby: I will prepare a delicious meal!

Mr. Karson: Hmm, wishes ...

Mr. Karson: *sighs* ... Failure to prepare a decent meal for Miss Sotheby is a stain on my butler career ...

Vertin: I think ... there is a way to address your problems, Mr. Karson.

Vertin: Enjoy the dinner Ms. Sotheby prepares for everyone tonight.

Mr. Karson: Huh!!!

Depths, Scorched Woods

Mr. Karson: The sun goes down.

Mr. Karson: The water on the ground has reached the ankle.

Mr. Karson: Out of the tent, a diminutive figure kneels on the ground. She seems to be murmuring.

Vertin: ... I didn't know you prayed.

Schneider: ...

Vertin: You're the last one to tell me your wish.

Vertin: ... Although you won't go, I still want to know.

Schneider: ...

Schneider: Do you want to hear my wish, my lord?

Schneider: Then my wish is ... don't forget me.

Vertin: Well ...

Choices

1. Ok. I got it.

Schneider: It's raining again.

Schneider: The buildings outside the suitcase start to melt, but no one mentions it.

Schneider: Sotheby's Chew-Chew Hallucinogen XII works. The refugees finally get to have real food.

Schneider: "Desire," as she said, is the symbol of the most important ingredient.

Sotheby: Ahh ...! I'm exhausted! How tiring it is to cook!

Sotheby: Finally we delivered the meals to all the refugees, but our soup became cold. Aww!

X: Oh? Thanks to your hallucinogen, what I see happens to be a parfait ...

X: *chewing* It also tastes the same ...

Druvis Ⅲ: I had the souffle. Miss Sotheby, thank you for the meal.

Man In Black: Fi-filet steak! Sorry I gotta have some more ...

Man In Black: Ptooey!!!

Sotheby: What happened? What's wrong?

Man In Black: Whoa ... what is that tast ...

Man In Black: It tastes like corned beef, dust and baseball gloves someone just wearing it ... oh ...

Everyone: *laughters*

Sotheby: Sir, you have to believe what you see!

Sotheby: If you don't believe it from the bottom of your heart, even the hallucinogen won't help!

Sotheby: Don't be fooled by the "Storm". What I prepared for you is definitely the best food in the world!

Mr. Karson: *cough*

Sotheby: Mr. Karson! What happened to you? Is there anything that doesn't suit your appetite?

Mr. Karson: No, it tastes amazing, my lady.

Sotheby: What did you eat, Mr. Karson?

Mr. Karson: A burnt Welsh rabbit.

Sotheby: ... Ah! That's ... that's my ...

Mr. Karson: The first cheese you made when you were eight. And you burnt the tulips in the Chelsea Flower Show.

Mr. Karson: ...

Mr. Karson: That's a relief to me, my lady.

Mr. Karson: Please take this.

Sotheby: What's this thick book ...?

Mr. Karson: The records of all the important transactions and dealings of our manor, some secret lists, and the location of the treasury.

Mr. Karson: These are Master and Madam's favourite wine and weekly schedules.

Sotheby: Okay. But ... the second half seems to be all about ...

Mr. Karson: All of your favourite menus.

Mr. Karson: You want different dishes every day, and new preferences every time ...

Mr. Karson: Hah, one is barely enough.

Mr. Karson: My lady, please take good care of yourself.

Mr. Karson: Try to get in touch with Master and Miss Moissan after everything ends.

Mr. Karson: You will be a fair lady, Ms. Sotheby.

Sotheby: I will do my best! ... But why didn't you hand it to father in person?

Sotheby: Enormous sound of rain comes from outside the suitcase.

Sotheby: Whoa ...

Sotheby: What a heavy rain outside ...

Sotheby: The rain turned upside down! Oh my ...

Sotheby: Come and see! Mr. Karson, quick!

Sotheby: ... Hmm?

Sotheby: Mr. Karson ... where are you?

Vertin: ...

Vertin: The "Storm" is here.

Marian: Thanks for your treat ...

Man In Black: I-I can have one ... more ...

Marian: Holy Mary pray for us ... Holy Mary pray for us ...

Marian: Look after us ... Have compassion on us ...

Schneider: Don't be afraid, sis. Take my hand. Close your eyes ... Just like when we were born ...

Schneider: Everything will be fine ...

Vertin: ...

Vertin: ... Goodbye.

Schneider: *cough* ... My lord ...

Vertin: Schneider ... I'm sorry.

Vertin: Your family ...

Schneider: No, my lord.

Schneider: She stands on her feet, runs towards Vertin and falls into her embrace gently. Now, once again, she looks like a pale pigeon.

Schneider: Hold me.

Vertin: ...!

Schneider: I am sorry. I'm not a real arcanist.

Vertin: What do you mean? I-I don't understand ...

Schneider: I always wanted to be lucky, but ... I think I should say goodbye now.

Vertin: Goodbye?! You mean the "Storm" will also ...

Vertin: No!!! Why? ... You've never eaten the gold bar in front of us!!

Vertin: Are you always tolerating it?!

Schneider: Heh heh ...

Schneider: Now it's coming, my lord ...

Schneider: Don't forget me.

Schneider: Don't forget my heartbeat on the right.

THE END